



UNIFORM & APPEARANCE STANDARDS

Richardson Police Department • Public Safety Cadets



PUBLIC SAFETY CADETS

RICHARDSON POLICE DEPARTMENT

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Why Uniform Policies Matter

Uniform policies might seem like small details — making sure your shirt is tucked in, your belt is correct, your boots are polished. But in reality, these details represent something much bigger.

If you can't follow the small standards, how will you handle the bigger responsibilities?

Law enforcement is a profession built on discipline, attention to detail, and consistency. Uniformity isn't just about appearance — it's about mindset. It shows that you take pride in yourself and your team.

When Cadets consistently meet uniform standards, it reflects:

- **Respect** — for the unit, the program, and the people you serve.
- **Accountability** — doing what's expected, even when no one is watching.
- **Readiness** — showing that you're prepared to step up and represent law enforcement values.
- **Safety** — a clean, professional uniform reinforces your presence as part of a structured, disciplined team. It helps deter negative attention and signals that you are not to be taken lightly in public-facing roles.

Failure to meet basic expectations like uniform compliance is often a sign of bigger challenges: lack of discipline, poor time management, or resistance to structure. Uniformity builds the habits that prepare you for bigger challenges — in the Cadets program, in law enforcement, and in life.



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Uniform Types

The type of uniform worn for an event, meeting, or competition will be decided by a Cadet Sergeant or the most senior Cadet attending. Uniform will usually be announced via a message or calendar event. Cadets should all wear the same uniform unless specified otherwise.

Class A Uniform

Most formal uniform. Worn for most city events, competitions, and formal events. Also commonly worn to meetings.

Class B Uniform

Duty uniform commonly worn during weekly meetings. Cadets should make sure they are all wearing the same color. Will usually be announced along with the uniform type.

Polo Uniform

Worn when Cadets do not have the same uniform everyone else is wearing. Most commonly used by probationary Cadets.



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Class A Uniform

- **Class A Shirt** — Gray, long or short sleeve. Worn with a BLACK undershirt. No long sleeve undershirt with short sleeve shirt.
- **Class A Pants** — Navy with blue pinstripe.
- **Nametag** — Above right chest pocket, centered. Format: first initial last name (e.g. D. Hemmi). Size: 1/2 in × 2 3/8 in.
- **Award Bar(s)** — Directly above the nametag, centered. For multiple bars, consult a Cadet Sergeant for order.
- **Presidential Service Award** — Directly above the left patch, centered with the vertical line above the pocket.
- **Duty Belt** — See duty belt section for details.

Class B Uniform

- **Class B T-Shirt** — Gray or blue. Worn with a BLACK undershirt. BLACK long sleeve undershirt also acceptable.
- **BDU Pants** — Black BDU Pants (Cargo Pants).
- **Nametag** — Right chest, slightly above center of unit logo. Format: first initial last name. Size: 1/2 in × 2 3/8 in.
- **Duty Belt** — See duty belt section for details.

Polo Uniform

- **Polo Shirt** — Black polo shirt. Worn with a BLACK undershirt. BLACK long sleeve undershirt also acceptable.
- **BDU Pants** — Black BDU Pants (Cargo Pants).
- **Nametag** — Right chest, slightly above center of unit logo. Format: first initial last name. Size: 1/2 in × 2 3/8 in.
- **Duty Belt** — See duty belt section for details.



Class A Shirt Example



Class B Shirt Example



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Additional Equipment

Cadets should carry the following items for all uniform types:

- Whip Out (Notepad)
- Two Black Pens
- Handcuff Key
- Flashlight
- Radio Codes Sheet
- Miranda Card

Headgear

Baseball caps must be black with no obvious markings or logos. They can be purchased on your own.

Cadets are permitted to wear a baseball-style cap under the following circumstances:

- a. While directing traffic or investigating motor vehicle crashes.
- b. While working crime scenes or assigned as a perimeter unit for police incidents.
- c. When Cadets are to be out of their vehicles for an extended period of time.
- d. When assigned to work special events.

Black Watch Caps (Beanies) may be worn for winter wear only.



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Duty Belt Components

- **Outer Belt** — Basket weave outer belt that attachments slide onto. Goes over the inner belt.
- **Inner Belt** — Velcro inner belt through your pant belt loops. Velcro facing out.
- **Gun Holster** — Positioned at 3 o'clock (9 o'clock for lefties). Keep in the same place for consistency.
- **Cuff Pouch** — Easy-access location. Cuffs open side up, thin part toward front center, key holes facing out.
- **Radio / Holster** — Non-dominant side. Mic cord over dominant shoulder, mic clips at shirt center. Primary hand operates mic.
- **Flashlight Holder** — Non-dominant side. Easily accessible with your non-dominant hand.

Note: Keep the back of your belt empty — this helps protect your back during long shifts.



Belt Setup Example



Cuff Setup Example



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Boot Standards

- Boots should be polished at least once per month, before important events (city events, competitions, etc.), and/or when instructed.
- Black socks shall only be worn.
- Boots should remain clean and professional looking. Additional polishing or cleaning should be done as necessary.

Suggested Polishing Method

- 1 Clean boots with a rag.
- 2 Apply polish (Kiwi Parade Gloss Black or LeatherLuster) with cotton ball.
- 3 Apply a small amount of water with your cotton ball or finger.
- 4 Grab a fresh cotton ball and rub the polish until it is shiny again. You can reuse the same cotton ball until it no longer gets a shine.
- 5 Repeat from step 2 until satisfactory.

Only polish from the tip of the boot to where the crease is to avoid damaging the boot. Thicker base layers can be put on to help build it up.

Appearance Standards — Hair

- Hairstyles will not be a departure from the normal accepted business style.
- Hair should present a neat and clean appearance at all times.
- **Males** will not permit hair to extend below the top of the uniform shirt collar.
- **Females** shall wear their hair secured so as not to interfere with activities. Hair cannot extend more than six inches below the top of the uniform shirt collar. Putting hair into a bun is heavily encouraged.
- Accessories, such as bands, pins, or barrettes, shall be black or dark blue in color.

Facial Hair

Moustaches shall not extend below the upper lip or corners of the mouth, be overly thick, or unkempt. All moustaches shall be clean, neat, and trimmed in a manner which reflects positively on the Cadet and the police department. Unacceptable styles include Fu Manchu, Handlebar, Walrus, etc.

Beards and goatees will not be permitted unless approved by the Chief of Police.



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Tattoos, Body Art & Brands

Cadets are prohibited from displaying tattoos, body art, or brands on any part of the hands, neck, face, head, eyelids, mouth, and ears with the following exception:

- a. Permanent facial makeup on the eyebrows, eyeliner, and lips that is conservative.

Piercings

Wearing piercing hardware or jewelry in body piercings is prohibited if visible, with the following exception:

- a. Female Cadets may wear no more than two earrings in each ear lobe. Earrings should be studs or something that will not catch on stuff or can be pulled on.

Wristbands & Necklaces

Messages on any wristbands will be professional and not contain any messaging for commercial purposes. No more than two wristbands (one on each arm) may be worn at one time (with the exclusion of memorial bands and medical alert bracelets) and must not interfere with duty requirements or create a safety risk.

Necklaces should be tucked in to ensure professionalism and personal safety. If possible, necklaces should be removed completely.

Enforcement

Regular inspections will be held to maintain standards within the unit. Inspections will cover all of the topics in this guide.